GEMS OF INDIA

"Mental health does not improve through performative urgency. It requires patience, trust and sustained investment. Our measure of success is not how often we trend but whether care pathways are clearer, professionals feel supported and people seeking help face fewer barriers"

VASVI BHARAT RAM, *Founding Trustee, IMHA*



GUIDING MINDS Vasvi Bharat Ram and Ashish Bharat Ram (centre) with Dr Amit Sen and Dr Kavita Arora

HARDIK CHHABRA

WHY IT IS A GEM

- **United 250 organisations across 30+ states/UTs, enabling knowledge sharing**
- **Reached 1,600+ mental health professionals in 130+ cities through capacity-building programmes**
- **Centred voices of people with lived experience of mental illness for better implementation of the Mental Healthcare Act**

A defining principle of IMHA's approach is foregrounding 'lived experience expertise'. "Mental health cannot be looked at from a purely biomedical, expert-driven lens," explains Vasvi. "Care must be humane, trusted and responsive to communities." Alongside this, the alliance supports better implementation of the Mental Healthcare Act, 2017, working with governments as ecosystem partners.

Since its launch, IMHA has reached over 1,600 mental health professionals across more than 130 cities through capacity-building programmes, hosted national conventions, enabled peer learning, and mobilised philanthropic capital. Built quietly and collaboratively, it is working to ensure that mental health in India is accorded the structural priority it has long lacked. ■